

Assignment-8

215: kth Largest element in an Array:

215. Kth Largest Element in an Array Solved

Medium Topics Companies

Given an integer array `nums` and an integer `k`, return the k^{th} largest element in the array.

Note that it is the k^{th} largest element in the sorted order, not the k^{th} distinct element.

Can you solve it without sorting?

Example 1:
Input: `nums = [3,2,1,5,6,4]`, `k = 2`
Output: 5

Example 2:
Input: `nums = [3,2,3,1,2,4,5,6]`, `k = 4`
Output: 4

Constraints:

- $1 \leq k \leq \text{nums.length} \leq 10^5$
- $-10^4 \leq \text{nums}[i] \leq 10^4$

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```
Java  
3 PriorityQueue<Integer> pq = new PriorityQueue<>(Collections.reverseOrder());  
4 for(int i=0; i<nums.length; i++){  
5     pq.add(nums[i]);  
6 }  
7  
8 while(k>1){  
9     pq.poll();  
10    k--;  
11 }
```

Accepted 45 / 45 testcases passed
Raj Vardhan Singh Gangwar submitted at May 16, 2026 20:47

Runtime: 104 ms | Beats: 9.73%
Memory: 68.06 MB | Beats: 73.34%